

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦ J

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦ Q

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦ Q

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3 ♦
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥ J

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠ K

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5
♥ 10 6 4
♦ A 7 3
♣ A 10 9 8 2

♠ A K 9 8 7 3

♥ 8 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ J 4



♠ 10 4
♥ A Q J 3
♦ J 10 5 4
♣ K 7 6

♠ Q J 2

♥ K 9 7 5

♦ K Q 2

♣ Q 5 3

NORTH has a perfect hand for an opening bid of 2♠.

SOUTH will be tempted to respond with his opening hand and good trump support, but he should resist the temptation. To raise a Weak Two-bid to game you should have quick winners, not just points.

*West**North**East**South*

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by North

Lead: ♦ J

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 2
♥ A K 7 5
♦ A 7 2
♣ A 5 3

♠ 6 5

♥ Q 9 4

♦ K 5 4

♣ K 10 9 8 6



♠ A K 9 8 7 3

♥ 8 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ J 4

♠ 10 4

♥ J 10 6 3

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ Q 7 2

EAST has the same hand as in Deal 1 and again opens 2♠.

This is the type of hand WEST needs to bid game. Notice that even with all those winners the pair is nowhere close to having a slam. They will probably make just ten tricks.

*West**North**East**South*

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♦Q

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ A 10 9 4
♦ Q J 4 3
♣ K 10 8

♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 7 5

♦ A 7 2

♣ Q 7 5 3



♠ 5

♥ K Q J 6 3

♦ K 10 5

♣ A 9 6 2

♠ A K 9 8 7 3

♥ 8 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ J 4

Once more, SOUTH has the same hand as Deals 1 and 2.

This time NORTH has a very poor hand without any chance of making game. However, he should bid 4♠ anyway.

It is very likely that the opponents can make 4♥ if East gets the opportunity to get into the bidding. Hopefully the 4♠ bid will shut him out, and 4♠ probably won't go down more than a couple of tricks.

West	North	East	South
			2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♦Q			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 4 3

♥ 8 5

♦ K Q J 9 8 6 2

♣ 9 7

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ J 10 4 3

♦ A 10

♣ K J 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 7 6

♥ A 6 2

♦ 5 3

♣ A Q 8 3

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q 9 7

♦ 7 4

♣ 10 6 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

3♦

All Pass

3♦ by West

Lead: ♥J

WEST has a pretty normal preemptive 3♦ bid.

EAST has the equivalent of an opening 1NT bid and will be very tempted to bid 3NT.

That might turn out to be a disaster, particularly if EAST is unable to reach the WEST hand.

EAST should assume WEST can win six tricks if ♦s are trumps. Thinking this way points EAST to her best call - PASS.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 5
♥ 8 6 5
♦ Q J 9 8 7
♣ K J

♠ 8 7

♥ K Q J 9 7 3 2

♦ 5

♣ 8 6 4



♠ K 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 10 3 2

♣ A Q 10 5 3 2

♠ A J 10 6 4 3

♥ A

♦ A K 6 4

♣ 9 7

Here SOUTH has the kind of hand you need to raise a preempt to game.

SOUTH assumes that NORTH has a hand with six winners in it. He can provide four more, so that is just enough for game. He bids 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♠K